Ans. (d): Statement 1 : It involves 12 pacific-rim countries: the US, Japan, Malaysia, Vietnam, Singapore, Brunei, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, Mexico, Chile and Peru. It's not an agreement between all the pacific rim countries except Russia and China. Only 12 out of nearly 50+ Rim countries are part of it.

Statement 2 : It is a trade bloc. So (2) is incorrect.

96. Consider the following statements :

The India-Africa Summit

1. held in 2015 was the third such Summit
2. was actually initiated by Jawaharlal Nehru in 1951

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a): India- Africa Summit stated in 2008 (first-summit) is one of the most spectacular diplomatic exercises hosted by India since the 1893 Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) summit.

The second and third summits were held in 2011 and 2015. So (1) is correct and (2) is incorrect.

97. `SWAYAM, an initiative of the Government of India, aims at

(a) Promoting the Self Help Groups in rural areas
(b) Providing financial and technical assistance to young start-up entrepreneurs
(c) Promoting the education and health of adolescent girls
(d) Providing affordable and quality education to the citizens for free

Ans. (d): SWAYAM Study Webs of Active Learning for Young Aspiring Minds programme of ministry of Human Resource Development, GoI. Professors of centrally funded institutions like IITs, IIMs, central universities will offer online courses to the citizen of India. All courses would be offered free of cost under this programme.

98. Consider the following statements

1. New Development Bank has been set up by APEC. ।
2. The headquaters of New Development Bank is in Shanghai.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): The proposal for setting up the New Development Bank (NDB) was given by India at the 4th BRICS summit in 2012 held in Delhi.

- The NDB was created by BRICS in 2014. Hence (1) is incorrect.
- It is headquartered in Shanghai, China. Hence (2) is correct.
- The first regional office of the NDB is in Johannesburg, South Africa. The major role of the bank is to support public or private projects through loans, guarantees, equity participation and other financial instruments.

99. Which of the following is NOT a member of 'Gulf Cooperation Council' ?

(a) Iran
(b) Saudi Arabia
(c) Oman
(d) Kuwait

Ans. (a) : It is a political and economic alliance of six Middle East countries like Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, the United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Bahrain and Oman.

100. 'Global Financial Stability Report' is prepared by the

(a) European Central Bank
(b) International Monetary Fund
(c) International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
(d) Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development

Ans. (b) : Global Financial Stability Report is published by International Monetary Fund. It assesses the stability of global financial markets and emerging market financing. Topics covered in the GFSR usually include system risk assessments in world side financial markets, worldwide debt management, emerging economic markets and current economic crises that could affect finances worldwide.

UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2015

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **(Exam date : 23.08.2015)** **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Prehistoric Period

1. With reference to the art and archaeological history of India, which one among the following was made earliest?

(a) Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar
(b) Rock-cut Elephant at Dhauli
(c) Rock-cut Monuments at Mahabalipuram
(d) Varaha Image at Udayagiri

Ans : (b) The Lingaraja a temple at Bhubaneswar was built by Yayati Keshari in the 11th Century (1025-1040AD) the Rock – cut Elephant at Dhauli (Odisha) was built during the period of the Mauryan rules. Ashoka in 250BC happened around the Rock – cut Monuments at Mahabalipuram were build during the Pallava reign in the 7th - 8th Centuries. The Varaha statue at Udayagiri (Vidhisha Madhya Pradesh) was built by Chandragupta –II during the Gupta Period.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata and Shaiva Religion

2. Which of the following kingdoms were associated with the life of the Buddha?

1. Avanti 2. Gandhara
3. Kosala 4. Magadha

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 3 and 4 only

Ans : (d) Magadha, Kosala, Vaishali, Vajji etc. were the kingdoms and regions that the wandering Buddha covered relentlessly. Jetavana was perhaps the best known amongst the beautiful gardens provided to Buddha's entourage and it was close to Sravasti, capital of the Kosala Kingdom. Perhaps the second-most important monastic resort of Buddha was the "bamboo grove" in Rajgriha, capital of Magadha, provided by king Bimbisara.

• Gupta Period and Post-Gupta Period

3. With reference to Indian history, which of the following is/are the essential element/elements of the feudal system?

1. A very strong centralized political authority and a very weak provincial or local political authority
2. Emergence of administrative structure based on control and possession of land
3. Creation of lord-vassal relationship between the feudal lord and his overlord

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (b) Feudalism in its various forms usually emerged as a result of the decentralization of an empire authority of the centre which diminished as local/ feudal power emerged. The administrative and social structuring of society is around relationships derived from the holding of land in exchange for service or labour landed nobility held lands from the Crown in exchange for military service and vassals were in turn into tenants of the noble, while the peasants were obliged to live on their lord's land and give him homage, labour, and a share of the produce, nationally in exchange for military protection.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

• Bahmani and Vijayanagara Empire

4. Who of the following founded a new city on the south bank of a tributary to river Krishna and undertook to rule his new kingdom as the agent of a deity to whom all the land south of the river Krishna was supposed to belong?

(a) Amoghavarsha I (b) Ballala II
(c) Harihara I (d) Prataparudra II

Ans : (c) Vijayanagara or 'City of Victory' was the name of both a city and an empire. The empire was founded in the 14th century. In its heyday, it stretched from the river Krishna in the north to the extreme south of the peninsula, in the Krishna-Tungabhadra doab.

• Mughal Empire

5. Consider the following pairs :

Medieval Indian State		Present Region
1. Champaka	:	Central India
2. Durgara	:	Jammu
3. Kuluta	:	Malabar

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only